

dealt with and anti retroviral (ARV) drugs are required only if the CD 4 count falls below 200/cumm & or if the opportunistic infections are life threatening. Individuals with normal CD4 count are kept under follow-up with repeated CD4 count.

With availability of ART, incidence of complications known to occur in AIDS patients such as cancers and infections has considerably reduced & provide them with a better quality of life.

Efforts by Delhi Government

Delhi government has been making sincere endeavours to prevent AIDS besides ensuring better care for the patients. Apart from other initiatives, Hon'ble Chief Minister Smt. Sheila Dikshit inaugurated 15 new ICTC Centres in addition to 57 existing ones. Besides, blood donation camps were organised on the occasion of International Blood Donation Day on 1st October, 2007. Trainings were conducted throughout the year for Health Workers, NGOs on HIV/AIDS.

Stigma and Discrimination against people living with HIV/AIDS

Ever since scientists identified HIV and AIDS, social responses of fear, denial, stigma and discrimination have accompanied the epidemic. And this unjustified discrimination has spread rapidly, causing anxiety and prejudice against the groups most affected, as well as those living with HIV or AIDS. Needless to say, that HIV and AIDS are as much about social phenomena as they are about biological and medical concerns. Across the world the global epidemic of HIV/AIDS has shown itself

capable of triggering responses of compassion, solidarity and support, bringing out the best in people, their families and communities. But the disease is also associated with stigma, repression and discrimination, as individuals affected (or believed to be affected) by HIV have been rejected by their families, their loved ones and their communities, associated with stigma, repression and discrimination, as individuals affected (or believed to be affected) by HIV have been rejected by their families, their loved ones and their communities.

The impact of HIV/AIDS on women, particularly in India, is particularly acute. In many developing countries, women are often economically, culturally and socially disadvantaged and lack equal access to treatment, financial support and education. In a number of societies, women are mistakenly perceived as the main transmitters of sexually transmitted diseases (STDs). Together with traditional beliefs about sex, blood and the transmission of other diseases, these beliefs provide a basis for the further stigmatisation of women within the context of HIV and AIDS. HIV-positive women are treated very differently from men in our country. Men are likely to be 'excused' for their behaviour that resulted in their infection, whereas women are not.

Every one should be aware that HIV or AIDS doesn't spread through touching, hugging, kissing or any other contact with HIV? AIDS patient, except unprotected sex. All the society members need to change their attitude towards them so that they get to spend their life with the respect and care they deserve.

